

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1983-02-02

TO THE FOLLOWERS OF BAHÁ'U'LLÁH IN EVERY LAND

354.1 WE BOW OUR HEADS IN INFINITE GRATITUDE TO THE BLESSED BEAUTY FOR HIS ALL- EMBRACING CONFIRMATIONS ENABLING HOUSE JUSTICE OCCUPY ITS NEWLY

CONSTRUCTED PERMANENT SEAT. THIS AUSPICIOUS EVENT SIGNALIZES ANOTHER

PHASE IN PROCESS FULFILLMENT SAILING GOD'S ARK ON MOUNTAIN OF THE LORD AS

ANTICIPATED IN TABLET CARMEL, WONDROUS CHARTER WORLD SPIRITUAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE CENTERS FAITH BAHÁ'U'LLÁH.

455354.2 THIS HIGH POINT HISTORY STRUGGLING FAITH NOW EMERGING FROM OBSCURITY, THIS CRUCIAL HOUR SUFFUSED WITH UNTOLD POTENCIES GENERATED BY SOUL-

STIRRING SACRIFICES BELOVED BRETHREN IRAN, MARKED BY VISIT MEMBERS HOUSE

JUSTICE TWIN HOLY SHRINES AND FIRST GATHERING COUNCIL CHAMBER TOGETHER

WITH HANDS CAUSE AMATU'L-BAHÁ RÚ HÍYYIH KHÁNUM 'ALÍ-AKBAR FURÚTAN AND

COUNSELOR MEMBERS INTERNATIONAL TEACHING CENTER TO OFFER PRAYERS

HUMBLE THANKSGIVING. LET ALL REJOICE. LET PRAISES ANCIENT BEAUTY RESOUND. MAY UNRELENTING EFFORTS FRIENDS EVERYWHERE HASTEN ADVENT THAT DAY

WHEN WONDROUS POTENTIALITIES ENSHRINED IN TABLET CARMEL WILL BE FULLY

REVEALED AND WHEN FROM GOD'S HOLY MOUNTAIN, AS ENVISAGED BELOVED GUARDIAN, WILL STREAM FORTH RIVERS OF LAWS AND ORDINANCES WITH ALL- CONQUERING POWER AND MAJESTY.

UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

355 Execution of Two Bahá'ís in Shiraz

14 M ARCH 1983

To all National Spiritual Assemblies

355.1 DISTRESSED ANNOUNCE EXECUTION BY HANGING ON 12 MARCH TWO INNOCENT

FRIENDS SHIRAZ YADU'LLÁH MA ĤMÚDNIZHÁD AND RA ĤMATU'LLÁH VAFÁ'Í. THIS

HEINOUS CRIME PERPETRATED ON MORROW PASSAGE RESOLUTION UNITED NATIONS

HUMAN RIGHTS COMMISSION EXPRESSING CONCERN VIOLATION FUNDAMENTAL

FREEDOMS AND REQUESTING SECRETARYGENERAL CONTINUE EFFORTS SAFEGUARD

RIGHTS BAHÁ'ÍS IRAN. ...

355.2 SUPPLICATING DIVINE THRESHOLD DELIVERANCE BRETHREN IRAN BRAVELY

FACING INTENSE CRUELITIES.

UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

456356 Execution of Mrs. Ṭúbá Za'irpúr in Shiraz

15 M ARCH 1983

To all National Spiritual Assemblies

356.1 FURTHER OUR TELEX 14 MARCH JUST LEARNED DISTRESSING NEWS MRS. ṬÚBÁ

ZÁ'IRPÚR WAS EXECUTED BY HANGING TOGETHER TWO FRIENDS MENTIONED OUR

PREVIOUS MESSAGE. BODIES OF THREE WERE BURIED IN BAHÁ'Í CEMETERY BY PRISON GUARDS WITHOUT KNOWLEDGE, PRESENCE RELATIVES. EXECUTIONS WERE NOT

ANNOUNCED EVEN TO FAMILIES....

UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

357 Message to Youth Conferences in Costa Rica and Honduras

17 M ARCH 1983

The Bahá'í Youth Conferences in Costa Rica and Honduras

357.1 WARMLY WELCOME OCCASION SIMULTANEOUS CONFERENCES COSTA RICA AND

HONDURAS TO GREET VIBRANT BAHÁ'Í YOUTH CENTRAL AMERICA. YOUR

ENTHUSIASTIC EXERTIONS IN SERVICE CAUSE BAHÁ'U'LLÁH AS SHOWN BY

SUBSTANTIAL INCREASE YOUR NUMBERS BRING GLADNESS TO OUR HEARTS AND

INSPIRE EXHILARATING THOUGHT THAT BRIGHT PROSPECTS SUCCESS LIE

IMMEDIATELY BEFORE YOU.

357.2 YOU MEET AT HIGHLY CRITICAL MOMENT HISTORY WHEN TURMOIL ASSOCIATED

WITH THIS ERA OF TRANSITION INTENSIFIES. WITHIN CAUSE ITSELF CAN BE SEEN ON ONE HAND UNPRECEDENTED CAMPAIGN PERSECUTION LONG-SUFFERING IRANIAN

BRETHREN AND ON OTHER HAND RESOUNDING TRIUMPHS SEVEN YEAR PLAN INDUCED

BY THEIR SACRIFICES AND SYMBOLIZED BY OCCUPANCY PERMANENT SEAT

UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE. MANKIND RAPIDLY APPROACHES RECKONING WITH

BAHÁ'U'LLÁH'S INJUNCTION THAT IT BE UNITED. FROM FAR AND NEAR ANGUISHED

MULTITUDES CRY FOR PEACE BUT BEING LARGELY IGNORANT HIS LIFE-REDEEMING

MESSAGE THEY FEEL NO HOPE. SITUATION THUS PRESENTS BAHÁ'Í YOUTH WITH GREAT OPPORTUNITIES INESCAPABLE CHALLENGE TO RESCUE THEIR PEERS FROM

SLOUGH DESPONDENCY POINTING THEM TOWARDS HOPE-RESTORING BANNER MOST

GREAT NAME. HOW FITTING THEN THAT YOU SHOULD CONSIDER AT THESE

CONFERENCES BEST MEANS EQUIP YOURSELVES SPIRITUALLY TO FULFILL TEACHING

MISSION PARTICULARLY SUITED TO YOUR CAPACITIES FOR SERVICE, YOUR ABOUNDING ZEAL AND ENERGY.

357.3 ARDENTLY SUPPLICATING AT HOLY THRESHOLD ON YOUR BEHALF THAT IN ADDITION TO PRAYING, ABSORBING HOLY PRINCIPLES AND TEACHING FAITH, YOU

WILL BE SO IMBUED BY BELOVED MASTER'S EXAMPLE SERVICE TO HUMANITY AS TO

457BE ABLE THROUGH YOUR INDIVIDUAL AND COLLECTIVE DEEDS TO DEMONSTRATE

CIVILIZING POWER OUR SACRED CAUSE AND CONVEY VISION ITS SPIRITUAL AND SOCIALLY CONSTRUCTIVE BENEFITS TO YOUR COMPATRIOTS OF ALL AGES.

UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

358 Ridván Message 1983

RIDVÁN 140[1983 A.D.]

To the Bahá'ís of the World Dearly loved Friends, 358.1 The observable acceleration, during the past decade, of the two processes described by our beloved Guardian, the disintegration

of the old order and the progress and consolidation of the new World Order of Bahá'u'lláh, may well come to be regarded by future historians as one of the most remarkable features of this period. The recent increase in this very acceleration is even more remarkable. Both within and without the Cause of God, powerful forces are operating to bring to a climax the twin tendencies of this portentous century. Among the many evidences which reveal this process may be cited, on the one hand, the continual increase of lawlessness, terrorism, economic confusion, immorality and the growing danger from the proliferation of weapons of destruction, and on the other, the worldwide, divinely propelled expansion, consolidation and rapid emergence into the limelight of world affairs of the Cause itself, a process crowned by the wonderful efflorescence of Mount Carmel, the mountain of God, whose Divine springtime is now so magnificently burgeoning.

The Dialectic of Triumph and Disaster 358.2 During the past five years, the historical dialectic of triumph and disaster has operated simultaneously within the Cause of God. The Army of Light has sustained the loss of six Hands of the Cause and waves of bitter persecution which have again engulfed the long-suffering community in Iran, and have resulted in the razing of the House of the Báb, the demolition of Bahá'u'lláh's ancestral home in Tákur, and the martyrdom of scores of valiant souls. Yet these disasters have called forth fresh energies in the hearts of the friends, have fed the deep roots of the Cause and given rise to a great harvest of signal victories. Chief among these are the successful conclusion of the Five Year Plan; the launching of the Seven Year Plan, now in the final year of its second phase and unprecedented proclamation of the Faith to Heads of States, parliaments and parliamentarians, government ministers and officials, leaders of thought and people prominent in the professions, resulting in a change of attitude on the part of the mass media, which now increasingly approach us for information about the Cause.

358.3 To these movements must be added the worldwide observances commemorating the fiftieth anniversary of the passing of the Greatest Holy Leaf, the completion of the restoration of the upper floor of the House of 'Abdu'lláh Páshá, and its opening, at this very time, to its first

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]